

scripts/commit_all.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-05-14 (1.2.23 cycle) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.18 (script documentation mandate) + §11.4.22 (lightweight commit path) + Lava §6.AD (HelixConstitution Inheritance) + §6.W (GitHub + GitLab only mirror policy)

Overview

Project-official commit + multi-mirror-push wrapper for the Lava parent repository. HelixConstitution mandates a project commit wrapper (CLAUDE.md "MANDATORY COMMIT & PUSH CONSTRAINTS"); Lava's wrapper is scoped to the §6.W 2-mirror set (GitHub + GitLab) and refuses destructive operations without explicit per-operation operator authorization per §9.

This is the **lightweight path** for routine commits. The wrapper:

1. Stages files (all-tracked or explicit --files list)
2. Commits with the supplied message
3. Pushes to every configured GitHub + GitLab named remote (github, gitlab)
4. Verifies §6.C convergence (every mirror's HEAD matches local HEAD)
5. Reports diagnostics on failure

Prerequisites

- git ≥ 2.30 in PATH
- Local clone with at least one of: github, gitlab named remotes (use `git remote add github git@github.com:...`)
- core.hooksPath set to .githubhooks (one-time per clone): `git config core.hooksPath .githubhooks`

- For commits that touch test files / gate-shaping files: a Bluff-Audit: stamp in the commit message body per Seventh Law clause 1 + §6.N.1.2
- For commits that add a new constitutional clause (##### 6.X in CLAUDE.md): a Classification: line per HelixConstitution §11.4.17

Usage

Basic commit + push (all tracked changes)

```
scripts/commit_all.sh -m "fix(feature): one-line summary"
```

Stages every modified + new tracked file, commits, pushes to GitHub + GitLab.

Commit specific files only

```
scripts/commit_all.sh -m "docs: update CONTINUATION" --files docs/CONTINUATION.md
```

Stages ONLY the listed files (no `git add -A` global add). Useful when:

- Multiple unrelated changes are in the working tree but only one belongs in this commit
- Submodules are nested-dirty but the parent change should not bump pins
- Large doc edits should not pull in stray test changes

Commit without push

```
scripts/commit_all.sh -m "wip: experimenting" --no-push
```

Useful for staging WIP commits that are not yet ready to share.

Diagnostic mode

```
scripts/commit_all.sh --status
```

Reports the repo path, branch, HEAD SHA, configured remotes, and a list of dirty files (first 20). Does NOT modify state.

Amend (operator-authorized only)

```
scripts/commit_all.sh --amend
```

REJECTED with exit code 5. Per HelixConstitution §9 absolute-data-safety, destructive operations (history rewrite, force-push, branch deletion) require explicit per-operation operator authorization. The wrapper's standing rule: NO amend. If genuinely needed, the operator runs `git commit --amend` directly after backing up `.git`.

Inputs

Argument	Required?	Description
<code>-m, --message <msg></code>	yes (unless <code>--status</code>)	Commit message body
<code>--files <f1> <f2> ...</code>	no	Stage only the listed paths (default: stage all tracked changes)
<code>--no-push</code>	no	Skip push; commit only
<code>--amend</code>	no	Rejected with exit 5 (operator must use <code>git commit --amend</code> directly)
<code>--status</code>	no	Diagnostic mode; reports state without modifying
<code>-h, --help</code>	no	Print usage and exit

Outputs

- Newly-created commit on local HEAD
- Push to every configured `github` + `gitlab` named remote
- §6.C convergence check report (✓ or ✗ per mirror)
- Exit code 0 on success

Exit codes

Code	Meaning
0	Committed + pushed (or committed only with <code>--no-push</code>)
1	Usage error (missing required arg)
2	Git operation failed (commit failed)
3	Nothing to commit (informational, not error)
4	Push failed for one or more mirrors

Code	Meaning
5	Operator confirmation required for destructive flag (<code>--amend</code>)

Side-effects

- Modifies index, HEAD, refs/heads/master (the active branch)
- Pushes to remote refs (this is destructive in the sense that it advances remote state; per §6.W only github + gitlab are touched)
- Triggers the pre-push hook (`.githooks/pre-push`) which runs Layer 1 (anti-bluff checks) + Layer 2 (`scripts/ci.sh --changed-only`)

Edge cases

Multiple remotes named github but pointing to different upstreams

The wrapper pushes to every remote named exactly github or gitlab. If you have additional named remotes (upstream, origin with mixed push URLs, helixdevelopment-fork, etc.), they are NOT pushed by the wrapper. Per §6.W, only github + gitlab are mandated mirrors for the Lava parent.

Submodules with nested-dirty state

If `submodules/X` shows `m` (lowercase, sub-submodule modified) in `git status`, the parent commit does NOT include the submodule unless explicitly listed in `--files`. This is intentional — pre-existing nested-dirty state should not silently advance the parent's pin.

Commit body includes -- token

Argument parsing stops `--files` consumption on the first token starting with `-` (single or double dash). Pass `-m BEFORE --files` to avoid the message being parsed as a file path.

Internal behaviour

The wrapper is intentionally thin (~180 lines). It does not:

- Run tests directly (Layer 2 of pre-push hook does that via `scripts/ci.sh --changed-only`)
- Regenerate auto-generated docs (HelixConstitution §11.4.12 — TODO §6.AD-debt for the export-regeneration pipeline integration)
- Handle submodule pin bumps (use direct `git submodule add / git add submodules/<name>` for those)

Related scripts

- `.githooks/pre-push` — invoked automatically on push; runs anti-bluff checks + `ci.sh`
- `scripts/ci.sh --changed-only` — Layer 2 pre-push gate (Spotless, changed-module unit tests, constitution parser, hermetic bash test suites)
- `scripts/check-constitution.sh` — invoked from `ci.sh`; verifies clauses 6.A through 6.AD + §6.W boundary + no-guessing vocabulary
- `scripts/firebase-distribute.sh` — release distribute (not invoked from `commit_all`)
- `scripts/inject-helix-inheritance-block.sh` — §6.AD-debt closure tool; idempotent inject of inheritance pointer-blocks

Cross-references

- HelixConstitution `CLAUDE.md` "MANDATORY COMMIT & PUSH CONSTRAINTS"
- HelixConstitution `Constitution.md` §11.4.22 (lightweight commit path)
- HelixConstitution `Constitution.md` §11.4.18 (script documentation mandate — this very document satisfies §11.4.18 for `commit_all.sh`)
- Lava `CLAUDE.md` §6.AD (HelixConstitution Inheritance)
- Lava `CLAUDE.md` §6.W (GitHub + GitLab only mirror mandate)
- Lava `CLAUDE.md` §6.T.3 (no-force-push)